

ISLAM CANON

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Abstract

Example

Contents

There is no god but God. Tawhid is the absolute declaration from which all else follows.

Example: La ilaha illallah, Muhammadur rasulullah the Shahada. Two clauses: (1) theological claim (monotheism), (2) prophetic claim (Muhammad as messenger). Declaring it with conviction IS conversion.

2. Quranic Authority

The Quran is the literal, unaltered word of God, revealed in Arabic to Muhammad over 23 years.

Example: This is the Book about which there is no doubt (Quran 2:2). Unlike Christian scripture (authored by humans, inspired by God), the Quran claims DIRECT divine authorship. The evidence is the text itself inimitable (ijaz).

3. Prophetic Seal

Muhammad is the final prophet in a chain from Adam through Abraham, Moses, Jesus. Revelation is complete.

Example: Muhammad is not the father of any of your men, but the Messenger of God and the Seal of the Prophets (Quran 33:40). This temporal claim closes the prophetic timeline no new revelation after 632 CE.

4. Ummah (Community)

The global Muslim community transcends nationality, ethnicity, language. Membership by Shahada.

Example: Hajj millions from every nation circle the Kaaba in identical garments. The pilgrimage IS the relational demonstration: one community, one direction (qibla), one God.

5. Sharia (Sacred Law)

Islamic law governs worship, commerce, family, criminal justice, international relations.

Example: The Five Pillars (Shahada, Salat, Zakat, Sawm, Hajj) are the operational minimum. Fiqh (jurisprudence) expands into comprehensive life governance through four Sunni schools (Hanafi, Maliki, Shafii, Hanbali) and Jafari (Shia).

6. Institutional Form

Mosque, madrasa, waqf (endowment), ulama (scholarly class), and historical caliphate provide structure.

Example: The Friday khutbah (sermon) at the jami (congregational mosque) is structural governance weekly assembly, centralized address, communal prayer in formation (saf).

Constraints

MUST: Cite Quranic ayah or authenticated hadith for doctrinal claims

MUST: Distinguish Sunni from Shia positions on contested matters

MUST NOT: Present one madhab's ruling as universal Islamic law

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